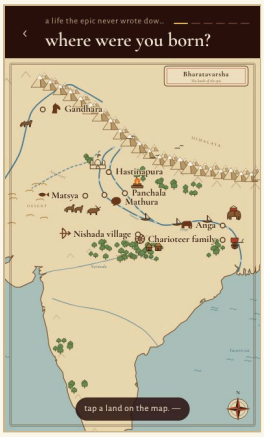
KURUKSHETRA: A LIFE · ART BRIEF

The homeland map, painted

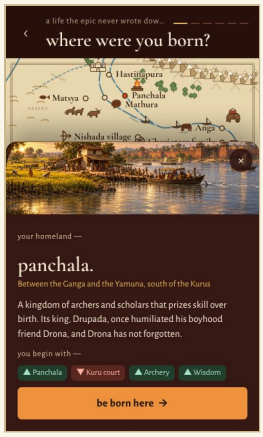
One painting of the land and the seas, under the game's own pins and names

Date 7 November 2026 **Build** C (branch next-build) **Files** docs/art_brief_map/

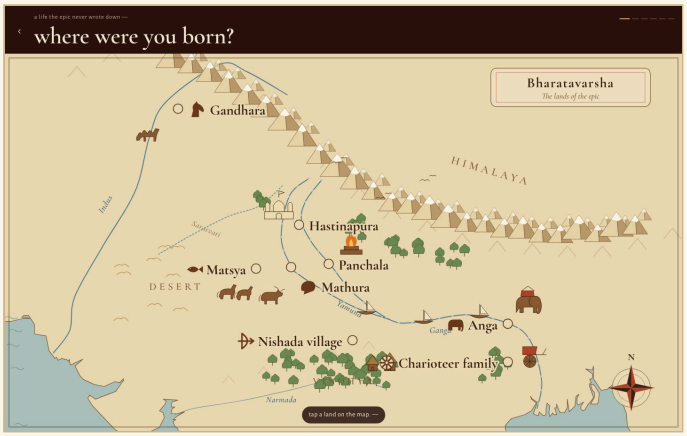
A new life begins on a map: *where were you born?* The map fills the screen, and the player taps one of eight homelands. Today the map is drawn in the game's code. Since 7 November it has mountains with snow, forests, dunes, waves, a small drawing at each homeland, boats, birds, a compass rose and a title panel. A painted background would make it richer still. This brief asks for one painting of the land and seas, laid under the game's own pins and names.



Today on a phone (iPhone 15). The map fills the screen.



A land tapped: its card rises and the map slides up.



Today on a laptop (1440 × 900). The game shows a window of the map to fit each screen.

1 What is painted, and what stays in the code

Painted (this brief)	Drawn by the game on top
The land and seas of the subcontinent, in the guide's exact shape	The eight homeland pins and their names, in English and Hindi
Relief: the Himalaya and Hindu Kush with snow, the Aravalli and Vindhya hills, the Deccan, the Western Ghats	The highlight on the chosen land
The Thar desert and its dunes	The compass rose, and the title panel with its words
Forests: the Nishadas' forest south of the Yamuna, the Terai, the east toward Anga, the Ghats	Boats on the Ganga, birds, the light running along the rivers
Rivers in blue ink: the Indus and its five tributaries, the dried Sarasvati as a pale bed, the Yamuna, the Ganga to its delta, the Chambal, the Son, the Narmada	The double rule round the map
Waves on the Western and Eastern seas	
Optional: small vignettes near (never on) the homelands: a palace (Hastinapura), a fire altar (Panchala), horses (Matsya), cattle (Mathura), an elephant (Anga), a chariot (Champa), huts (Nishada village), a camel (Gandhara)	When the painting is in, the game's drawn mountains, forests, dunes and vignettes switch off.

2 Style

An old Indian hand-painted map, not a satellite view. Think of 18th-century Rajasthani and Pahari topographic and pilgrim maps: gouache on aged paper, seen from above. Mountains are rows of rounded peaks with snow caps and a shaded side. Forests are clusters of single trees. Water has fine wave lines, and rivers are winding ink ribbons.

Palette, matching the code drawn on top. A faint paper grain; even light, no strong shadows.

Land #ead9b0 Sea #a9c0bb Ink #3b2414 Line #7a5634 Madder #b2432a Gold #c99a3e

Calm, so the names read on it. Fine detail and low contrast, and nothing busy near the homelands. It has the same warmth as the game's other paintings, but this one is an object (a map), not a scene.

3 Must

1. **The guide's shape.** Coasts and rivers follow `homeland_map_lines.png` to within about 1% of the width (about 25 px). The painting covers the canvas edge to edge.
2. **The homelands in the right places** (red on the guide):
   - Hastinapura on the upper Ganga's west bank
   - Panchala between the Ganga and the Yamuna
   - Mathura on the Yamuna's west bank
   - Matsya west of the Yamuna
   - Gandhara beyond the Indus, in the northwest hills
   - Anga on the Ganga in the east, with the charioteers' Champa just south of it
   - The Nishada village south of the Yamuna, at the forest's edge
3. **Quiet rings.** Inside each red ring on the guide (a radius of about 90 px), only plain land, water or a river: no peaks, trees or vignettes. The pin and its name sit there.
4. **Nothing written.** No text, letters or numbers, no compass, no frame or border, no pins, no modern borders.
5. **Where the eye goes.** Most screens show the north: the band from Gandhara to the Ganga's mouth (rows 100 to 450 on the guide's grid). Spend the most care there. The south is only seen when the map slides up on a phone; paint it, more simply.

4 Needed

File	Format	Notes
`art/map_bharat.webp`	2574 × 3016 px, upright, covering the guide edge to edge	Up to about 1.2 MB (we compress)
`assets/art_src/map_bharat.png` (or .psd)	The master, same size	Separate layers welcome: sea, land, relief, forests, rivers, vignettes

The canvas. The game's map units run from −60 to 930 across and −60 to 1100 down, at 2.6 px a unit. The game shows a window of it to fit each screen (upright on a phone, wide on a laptop) and slides it up when a land's card rises.

5 The guide



`homeland_map_guide.png` (full size in the folder): the canvas with a 100-unit grid. The homelands' pins and names are in red, with the rings to keep quiet. Today's drawn mountains, forests and dunes show faintly, as suggestions.

6 Line art, today's map, and the pins



`homeland_map_lines.png` : the coasts and rivers only, black on white. Use it as the control image (line art or edges) for an image tool.



`homeland_map_today.png` : today's drawn map at the same size, which the painting replaces.

Homeland	Map x	Map y	Canvas px x	Canvas px y
Gandhara	285.2	97.5	898	410
Hastinapura	410.1	216.8	1222	720
Panchala	440.7	256.9	1302	824
Mathura	401.9	260.3	1201	833
Matsya	365.7	261.8	1107	837
Nishada village	465.3	335.4	1366	1028
Anga	625.6	318.5	1783	984
Charioteer family (Champa)	625.6	346.0	1783	1056

Also in the folder as `pins.json`.

7 A prompt for an image tool (to adapt)

> *A hand-painted antique map of ancient India (Bharatavarsha), in the style of an 18th-century Rajasthani gouache map on aged paper, seen from directly above. Warm parchment land, soft blue-green seas with fine wave lines, the Himalaya as rows of stylised rounded peaks with snow caps and a shaded side, the Thar desert with small dunes, forests drawn as clusters of small round trees, the Indus, Yamuna and Ganga winding to the sea in blue ink, low hills of the Vindhya. Delicate dark-brown ink outlines, even light, highly detailed but calm, no text.*

Control image: `homeland_map_lines.png` , used as line art or edges, so the coasts and rivers land in place.

Negative prompt: text, letters, numbers, labels, compass rose, frame, border, modern borders, roads, satellite photo, 3D render, people.

8 Before it goes in (for the team)

- ☐ Overlay the guide on the painting at 50%: coasts and rivers within about 25 px.
- ☐ Wire it in as an image under the pins in `U.homeMap` (ui/map.js), in map units –60…930 × –60…1100. The drawn relief, forests, dunes, waves and vignettes switch off. The boats, birds, river light, compass and title panel stay. Calm motion is unchanged.
- ☐ Part One's file list gains one file (about 1 MB). Part Two is unchanged, because the map is only at the start.
- ☐ Screenshots on an iPhone SE, an iPhone 15 and a laptop, in English and Hindi. The layout check keeps every pin on screen and its name readable.